RESEARCH / ENVIRONMENT / INSTITUTIONAL ENGAGEMENT

# GORNJA SIGA

## Status Strategy

## 2026-2030

Research, Geographic Recognition, Environmental Stewardship and International Institutional Engagement Framework

STRATEGIC PLAN

Development of status, visibility and international engagement

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# 1. Executive Summary

This Strategic Plan establishes a coordinated framework for advancing the geographic, scientific, environmental, institutional and international visibility of Gornja Siga, a river island/ada situated on the Danube international waterway.

The strategy is based on the principle that the long-term position of Gornja Siga should not depend upon a single declaration, institution or act of political recognition. Instead, it should be strengthened through the gradual accumulation of verifiable evidence, cartographic presence, scientific research, environmental engagement, institutional participation, international visibility and documented stakeholder involvement.

The central strategic concept is therefore:

Research / Geographic Evidence / Mapping / Toponymic Consolidation / Scientific Publication / Environmental Stewardship / NGO Participation / Institutional Dialogue / International Visibility / Enhanced Negotiating Position / Potential Special Status or Management Arrangement

The Strategy recognizes that geographic recognition, environmental recognition, cartographic representation, institutional participation and territorial recognition are legally and politically different processes. The immediate objective is to advance those areas that can be pursued through research, publication, environmental stewardship and lawful institutional engagement, while simultaneously building a long-term evidence base relevant to broader questions concerning the status of Gornja Siga.

The Strategy will operate through three interconnected levels:

1. Strategic Level - long-term policy, international positioning and institutional objectives;
2. Operational Level - research, GIS, publications, NGO cooperation and conference participation;
3. Tactical Level - lawful field observation, environmental documentation and evidence collection.

The Strategic Plan covers the period 2026-2030.

# 2. Vision

The long-term vision is for Gornja Siga to become an internationally documented and geographically established Danube river island, recognized as a subject of scientific research, environmental importance, cartographic documentation and institutional discussion.

The Strategy seeks to create conditions under which Gornja Siga is increasingly treated not merely as an abstract political claim, but as:

- a geographically identifiable feature;
- a documented Danube river island/ada;
- a subject of historical and cadastral research;
- an object of geodetic and cartographic analysis;
- an environmental and biodiversity site;
- a subject of satellite and remote-sensing observation;
- a legitimate topic for scientific conferences;
- a stakeholder issue within relevant environmental and river-management discussions;
- a subject of international institutional awareness;
- and, in the longer term, a possible candidate for a specific cooperative, environmental, scientific or other special management arrangement.

# 3. Mission

The mission of the Gornja Siga Status Strategy is:

To establish a durable international record of the geographical existence, environmental relevance, historical development and institutional significance of Gornja Siga through independent research, geospatial documentation, scientific publication, NGO participation and engagement with relevant European and international frameworks.

The Strategy further seeks to promote:

- peaceful and evidence-based discussion;
- environmental stewardship;
- scientific cooperation;
- transparency;
- geographic documentation;
- lawful access to information;
- institutional dialogue;
- and the development of practical arrangements that reduce uncertainty and unnecessary conflict surrounding peaceful scientific, environmental and civil activities.

# 4. Central Strategic Objective

The central objective is to progressively strengthen the geographic and institutional position of Gornja Siga by creating a broad, cumulative network of evidence and engagement.

The Strategy does not assume that any individual organization can determine the sovereignty or territorial status of the area.

Instead, the objective is to ensure that:

The geographical feature known as Gornja Siga becomes increasingly documented, cited, mapped, researched, environmentally evaluated and institutionally visible, thereby creating a progressively stronger factual and stakeholder foundation for future discussions concerning its status, protection and management.

# 5. Primary Strategic Objectives

### Objective 1 - Geographical Recognition

To establish and consolidate Gornja Siga as a documented geographical toponym and identifiable river-island feature within academic, cartographic, GIS and environmental research.

### Expected result

A durable and citable geographic identity for:

Gornja Siga - Danube River Island / Ada

supported by:

- coordinates;
- hydrographic references;

- river kilometre references;
- historical maps;
- satellite imagery;
- GIS datasets;
- cadastral research;
- scientific publications;
- metadata records.

## Objective 2 - Cartographic and GIS Consolidation

To develop a comprehensive and reproducible geospatial record of Gornja Siga.

## Expected result

Creation of a:

GORNJA SIGA GEOSPATIAL OBSERVATORY

The Observatory will maintain:

- GIS layers;
- historical maps;
- satellite imagery;
- Copernicus data;
- orthophotos;
- elevation models;
- hydrographic information;
- vegetation mapping;
- cadastral interfaces;
- historical river-course reconstruction;
- metadata;
- version-controlled geographic products.

## Objective 3 - Environmental Recognition and Stewardship

To establish Gornja Siga as a subject of legitimate environmental research and conservation discussion.

## Expected result

Development of an independent environmental profile covering:

- biodiversity;
- vegetation;
- birdlife;
- wetlands;
- sediment;
- erosion;
- river morphology;
- invasive species;
- pollution;
- ecological connectivity;

- seasonal change.

## Objective 4 - NGO and Civil-Society Participation

To create or engage a legally established NGO platform capable of participating in environmental, scientific and public consultation processes.

## Strategic purpose

The NGO should provide a permanent institutional vehicle for:

- environmental research;
- participation in consultations;
- partnerships;
- grant applications;
- scientific cooperation;
- stakeholder meetings;
- conservation initiatives.

The NGO should present itself primarily as a body committed to:

Research, environmental stewardship and the peaceful documentation of Gornja Siga and the surrounding Danube ecosystem.

## Objective 5 - International Institutional Engagement

To engage relevant institutions according to their actual mandates.

The principal target areas include:

- ICPDR;
- Danube Commission;
- UNECE;
- OSCE;
- UNESCO-related environmental frameworks;
- DANUBEPARKS;
- WILDisland;
- relevant Ramsar and wetland initiatives;
- European scientific and geospatial networks;
- Copernicus-related communities;
- relevant border-management and analytical forums.

The Strategy shall avoid demanding that institutions exercise powers they do not possess.

Instead:

Each institution shall be approached on the basis of its own mandate, competence and institutional interest.

## Objective 6 - Scientific Internationalization

To establish Gornja Siga as a recurring subject of academic and professional research.

## Priority themes

- dynamic river borders;

- historical cadastre;
- river morphology;
- cartography;
- GIS;
- remote sensing;
- environmental stewardship;
- Danube governance;
- transboundary water cooperation;
- geographic naming;
- island ecology.

### Objective 7 - Predictable and Lawful Conditions for Activity

The Strategy seeks a long-term environment in which peaceful and lawful scientific, environmental and civil activities concerning Gornja Siga are conducted under clear, transparent and legally predictable conditions.

### The objective is:

To reduce uncertainty, document restrictions and incidents accurately, and promote transparent, proportionate and legally reviewable decision-making concerning access and activity.

The Strategy shall not organize unlawful border crossings, obstruction of authorities, confrontation with police or evasion of applicable legal requirements.

# 6. Strategic Pillar I: Geographical Recognition

## 6.1 Gornja Siga Gazetteer Programme

A standardized geographical record shall be prepared.

### Core record

Name: Gornja Siga

Feature type: Danube River Island / Ada

Alternative forms: Historical and linguistic variants where documented

Location: Danube international waterway

Coordinates: Verified geodetic coordinates

River reference: Applicable Danube river kilometre range

Description: Dynamic river-island feature subject to hydrological and morphological change

The record shall distinguish between:

- geographical facts;
- cadastral information;
- administrative claims;
- legal interpretations;
- political positions.

These categories must not be merged.

### 6.2 Toponymic Consolidation

The Strategy will promote consistent use of the name:

GORNJA SIGA

in:

- research papers;
- maps;
- GIS metadata;
- conference abstracts;
- environmental reports;
- academic presentations;
- data repositories;
- public communications.

The preferred descriptive form shall be:

Gornja Siga River Island / Ada on the Danube

The objective is to create citation continuity.

Every publication should, where appropriate, include:

- coordinates;
- map reference;
- coordinate reference system;
- date;
- dataset version;
- methodology.

### 6.3 Annual Gornja Siga Atlas

An annual atlas shall be developed.

### Proposed chapters

1. Geographic location;
2. Historical cartography;
3. Danube morphology;
4. Satellite observations;
5. Cadastral analysis;
6. Environmental conditions;
7. Vegetation;
8. Hydrology;
9. Navigation context;
10. Institutional and legal developments;
11. Annual changes.

The Atlas shall become the principal annual reference publication.

# 7. Strategic Pillar Ii: Cadastral And Geodetic Research

## 7.1 Gornja Siga Cadastral Research Project

A specialized research programme shall investigate the relationship between:

- historical cadastral systems;
- contemporary cadastral data;
- Danube river movement;
- Croatian parcel references;
- Serbian parcel references;
- apparent gaps or discontinuities;
- historical border interpretations.

One of the principal research subjects will be the apparent interface between the relevant Croatian and Serbian cadastral references.

The research shall not assume in advance that an apparent gap constitutes a legally meaningful terra nullius, cadastral void or absence of jurisdiction.

Instead, the research question shall be:

Does the apparent discontinuity represent an actual cadastral gap, a mapping difference, a coordinate transformation issue, historical river movement, incomplete public data or another form of legal or technical discontinuity?

## 7.2 Principal Study

A major academic and geodetic study should be prepared under the provisional title:

The HR025-RS121 Interface: A Geodetic and Cadastral Study of the Gornja Siga Area

The study should include:

- parcel geometry;
- coordinate systems;
- historical cadastral maps;
- river-course reconstruction;
- modern satellite imagery;
- GIS comparison;
- uncertainty analysis;
- legal interpretation clearly separated from geodetic findings.

# 8. Strategic Pillar Iii: Environmental Stewardship

## 8.1 Establishment of an Environmental Platform

An NGO or cooperating organization should be established or designated to conduct environmental and scientific work.

Possible functional identity:

Gornja Siga Environmental Research and Stewardship Initiative

Its activities may include:

- biodiversity surveys;
- vegetation mapping;
- bird monitoring;
- pollution observation;
- plastic monitoring;
- invasive species research;
- sediment observation;
- river morphology;
- ecological connectivity;
- environmental reporting.

### 8.2 Annual Environmental Status Report

A recurring publication should be issued:

State of the Gornja Siga Environment

The report should include:

| Research Area | Activity |
|---|---|
| Biodiversity | Species observations |
| Vegetation | Seasonal mapping |
| Water | Available monitoring and observations |
| Morphology | Satellite and GIS analysis |
| Pollution | Waste and contamination documentation |
| Connectivity | Relationship with surrounding habitats |
| Human pressure | Navigation and activity assessment |

The report should use reproducible and transparent methodology.

## 9. STRATEGIC PILLAR IV: WILDisland AND DANUBE ISLAND COOPERATION

Gornja Siga should be positioned within the wider context of Danube river islands.

The Strategy should study existing examples of:

- Danube islands subject to conservation;
- island acquisition;
- NGO stewardship;
- municipal management;
- ecological restoration;
- private conservation;

- inclusion in environmental networks.

A specific comparative workgroup should examine examples such as island acquisition and stewardship projects in the Danube region, including relevant Slovak and Bulgarian cases where reliable documentation is available.

### 9.1 Primary Institutional Objective

The first objective should not be a demand for political recognition.

The initial question should be:

Can Gornja Siga be scientifically assessed according to methodologies used for Danube river-island inventories, ecological connectivity and island conservation programmes?

This allows engagement on a technical basis.

### 9.2 WILDisland Engagement Package

Prepare a technical dossier containing:

1. geographical description;
2. satellite imagery;
3. island morphology;
4. ecological observations;
5. historical development;
6. current management situation;
7. environmental pressures;
8. research opportunities.

## 10. Strategic Pillar V: Unesco Mura-Drava-Danube Cooperation

The Strategy shall explore opportunities for scientific and environmental engagement within the broader Mura-Drava-Danube ecological framework.

The objective shall be:

- participation;
- scientific networking;
- biodiversity cooperation;
- data exchange;
- workshops;
- educational projects;
- environmental research.

The Strategy shall not claim that Gornja Siga is formally included in any UNESCO designation unless verified through official documentation.

The long-term objective is to demonstrate that:

The environmental significance of a geographically identifiable Danube island can be discussed independently from unresolved political or administrative questions.

# 11. Strategic Pillar Vi: Icpdr And Danube Environmental Governance

The ICPDR consultation process should be treated as one of the principal formal participation opportunities.

### 11.1 Gornja Siga Environmental and Hydro-Morphological Submission

Prepare a technical contribution addressing:

- river morphology;
- ecological connectivity;
- floodplain dynamics;
- sediment;
- biodiversity;
- pollution;
- erosion;
- monitoring gaps;
- cross-border information gaps.

The document should be evidence-based.

Political and territorial arguments, if included, should be placed in a separate contextual annex and should not compromise the scientific quality of the environmental submission.

### 11.2 Long-Term Objective

To establish Gornja Siga as a documented stakeholder subject in relevant discussions concerning:

- Danube management;
- environmental monitoring;
- flood risk;
- ecological connectivity;
- river morphology.

# 12. Strategic Pillar Vii: Danube Commission Engagement

The Danube Commission should be approached primarily concerning:

- navigation;
- hydrography;
- river sections;
- navigation safety;
- technical river information.

A technical memorandum should be prepared:

Gornja Siga and the International Navigation Regime of the Danube

Topics should include:

1. river kilometre;
2. navigable channel;
3. island morphology;
4. hydrographic development;
5. navigation charts;
6. historical changes;
7. interaction between the island and navigation.

### The objective is:

To establish the Gornja Siga river section as a legitimate subject of technical discussion.

## 13. Strategic Pillar Viii: Unece And Transboundary Cooperation

UNECE-related engagement should focus on:

- transboundary water cooperation;
- information exchange;
- environmental monitoring;
- flood-risk management;
- cooperation in geographically complex border areas.

The Strategy should use environmental and geographic complexity as an argument for:

More cooperation, more data, more transparency and better joint monitoring.

It should not be used as a justification for bypassing existing legal or institutional frameworks.

## 14. Strategic Pillar Ix: Osce Communication

Indirect and direct communication should be developed with relevant OSCE structures in Serbia and Croatia.

The preferred themes are:

- administrative transparency;
- cross-border communication;
- environmental cooperation;
- confidence-building;
- peaceful management of sensitive cross-border areas.

A standard briefing paper should be developed:

Gornja Siga: Cross-Border Administrative and Environmental Issues

The briefing should contain:

- factual chronology;
- geographic maps;
- environmental issues;
- documented incidents where independently verifiable;

- recommendations for dialogue.

## 15. Strategic Pillar X: Border-Geography And Analytical Engagement

A specialized research programme should examine the practical relationship between:

- geography;
- river morphology;
- border management;
- administrative practice;
- security perceptions.

The principal document should be:

Border Geography and Operational Ambiguity at Gornja Siga

The document should distinguish between:

- confirmed facts;
- official positions;
- competing legal interpretations;
- research hypotheses;
- documented incidents.

Any engagement with border-management institutions should be lawful, transparent and based on the objective of improving factual awareness.

The Strategy shall not seek to manipulate, fabricate or improperly influence operational intelligence.

## 16. Strategic Pillar Xi: Conference And Event Strategy

International conferences are a core instrument of the Strategy.

The objective is not merely attendance.

Each event should produce one or more of the following:

- academic paper;
- abstract;
- poster;
- map;
- professional contact;
- institutional meeting;
- data partnership;
- publication;
- follow-up proposal.

### Priority Conference Themes

### Theme 1 - Cadastre and River Borders

Historic Cadastre, River Migration and Territorial Interpretation: The Gornja Siga Case

### Theme 2 - GIS and Remote Sensing

Multi-Temporal Copernicus and GIS Analysis of a Dynamic Danube River Island

### Theme 3 - Drone Survey

High-Resolution Geospatial Documentation of Gornja Siga

Drone operations must comply with all applicable aviation, border, privacy and access regulations.

### Theme 4 - Environmental Science

River Islands as Transboundary Ecological Objects: The Gornja Siga Case

### Theme 5 - Toponymy

From Geographic Feature to International Toponym: The Cartographic Development of Gornja Siga

### Conference Strategy

Priority should be given to:

- EGU and relevant future assemblies;
- geodesy and cartography conferences;
- Copernicus and Earth-observation events;
- Danube-related conferences;
- environmental conferences;
- border-management and security conferences;
- relevant OSCE, UNECE and European workshops.

Participation in any specific event shall be subject to its actual programme, eligibility rules and current dates.

## 17. Strategic Pillar Xii: Copernicus, Gis And Open Geospatial Data

The Strategy shall maintain a permanent technical infrastructure:

GORNJA SIGA GEOSPATIAL OBSERVATORY

### Core functions

- satellite monitoring;
- change detection;
- land-cover observation;
- vegetation analysis;
- water-level comparison;
- shoreline mapping;

- historical map georeferencing;
- metadata production;
- GIS publication.

Relevant data from Copernicus, EuroGeographics, Esri and other sources should be used only in accordance with their applicable licences, terms and attribution requirements.

# 18. Strategic Pillar Xiii: International Declaration

A first declarative document should be prepared for communication through appropriate international channels.

### Proposed title

Gornja Siga International Geographic and Environmental Declaration

The Declaration should affirm:

1. the existence of Gornja Siga as an identifiable geographic feature;
2. commitment to peaceful activity;
3. commitment to environmental stewardship;
4. support for scientific research;
5. support for transparent geographic information;
6. willingness to cooperate;
7. commitment to biodiversity protection;
8. support for peaceful and lawful resolution of applicable disputes.

The document must not imply that submission or circulation automatically creates international recognition.

# 19. Strategic Pillar Xiv: Island Stewardship And Acquisition Workgroup

A specialist working group should investigate possible models of island acquisition, ownership and environmental stewardship.

### Research scenarios

### Scenario A - Private acquisition

Investigation of whether lawful acquisition is possible.

### Scenario B - NGO ownership or stewardship

Environmental ownership, management or conservation models.

### Scenario C - Cooperative management

Agreement between interested stakeholders.

### Scenario D - Scientific management zone

A framework prioritizing research and environmental monitoring.

### Scenario E - Future special arrangement

A longer-term proposal requiring the participation and agreement of competent authorities.

The working group shall examine comparative examples before adopting any specific acquisition strategy.

# 20. Organizational Structure

### I. Strategic Group

Gornja Siga Strategic Council

### Responsibilities

- long-term planning;
- international positioning;
- legal policy;
- institutional priorities;
- annual review;
- risk management.

### Suggested expertise

- international law;
- geodesy;
- cartography;
- GIS;
- environmental science;
- Danube navigation;
- NGO management;
- communications.

### Ii. Operational Group

Gornja Siga Research and International Engagement Unit

### A. GIS and Cartography Unit

Responsible for:

- maps;
- datasets;
- metadata;
- cadastral analysis;
- remote sensing.

### B. Legal and Institutional Research Unit

Responsible for:

- historical research;
- cadastral documentation;

- institutional mandates;
- comparative legal research.

### C. Environmental Research Unit

Responsible for:

- biodiversity;
- ecological monitoring;
- environmental reports;
- conservation partnerships.

### D. International Engagement Unit

Responsible for:

- ICPDR;
- WILDisland;
- UNESCO-related contacts;
- OSCE;
- UNECE;
- conferences;
- professional networks.

### E. Publications Unit

Responsible for:

- academic articles;
- reports;
- white papers;
- atlases;
- conference materials.

## Iii. Tactical Group

Gornja Siga Field Observation Team

The Field Team shall conduct only lawful and appropriately authorized activities.

### Functions

- photography;
- environmental observation;
- shoreline documentation;
- river morphology observation;
- biodiversity monitoring;
- field verification of satellite data;
- evidence preservation.

### Operational principle

Observe. Document. Preserve. Report. Avoid confrontation.

The team shall not be organized for:

- confrontation with police;
- obstruction of authorities;
- unlawful border crossing;
- evasion of border controls;
- unauthorized drone activity.

# 21. Incident And Evidence Protocol

Any relevant incident should be documented through a standardized procedure.

### Required elements

- date;
- time;
- location;
- coordinates where lawfully obtained;
- persons involved;
- factual description;
- photographs or video where lawful;
- official documents;
- witnesses;
- subsequent correspondence.

The record must distinguish clearly between:

- fact;
- allegation;
- interpretation;
- opinion.

A verified incident archive may support future legal, academic or institutional analysis.

# 22. Strategic Action Plan 2026-2030

### Work Package 1 - Foundation

Action 1 | Establish the Gornja Siga Strategic Council.

Action 2 | Create the Research and International Engagement Unit.

Action 3 | Establish the Geospatial Observatory.

Action 4 | Develop the standardized Gornja Siga Gazetteer record.

Action 5 | Create the central evidence repository.

Action 6 | Establish publication and data-management standards.

### Work Package 2 - Geography And Cadastre

Action 7 | Compile historical maps.

Action 8 | Collect and compare available cadastral information.

Action 9 | Conduct the HR025-RS121 interface study.

Action 10 | Reconstruct historical river-course changes.

Action 11 | Produce the first Gornja Siga Atlas.

Action 12 | Create a reproducible GIS database.

### Work Package 3 - Environment

Action 13 | Establish the environmental research programme.

Action 14 | Conduct an initial biodiversity baseline study.

Action 15 | Prepare a vegetation and habitat map.

Action 16 | Document pollution and environmental pressures.

Action 17 | Publish the first State of the Gornja Siga Environment report.

Action 18 | Develop cooperation proposals for Danube island initiatives.

### Work Package 4 - International Institutions

Action 19 | Prepare the ICPDR technical submission.

Action 20 | Develop a WILDisland technical dossier.

Action 21 | Explore UNESCO-related scientific and environmental engagement.

Action 22 | Prepare a Danube Commission technical memorandum.

Action 23 | Prepare a UNECE-oriented cooperation paper.

Action 24 | Prepare an OSCE briefing paper.

### Work Package 5 - Science And Events

Action 25 | Develop an annual conference calendar.

Action 26 | Submit abstracts to relevant geoscience and cartography events.

Action 27 | Prepare a major academic study on cadastre and river borders.

Action 28 | Present Copernicus and GIS research.

Action 29 | Develop professional partnerships.

Action 30 | Organize a specialist Gornja Siga research round table.

### Work Package 6 - International Declaration And Publication

Action 31 | Prepare the Gornja Siga International Geographic and Environmental Declaration.

Action 32 | Publish the annual Gornja Siga Status Report.

Action 33 | Publish academic articles.

Action 34 | Create a public research archive.

Action 35 | Develop a multilingual information package.

### Work Package 7 - Long-Term Status Options

Action 36 | Establish the Island Stewardship and Acquisition Working Group.

Action 37 | Study comparative Danube island cases.

Action 38 | Examine possible stewardship arrangements.

Action 39 | Develop alternative management scenarios.

Action 40 | Prepare a long-term Special Status or Cooperative Management Concept.

# 23. Implementation Timeline

### Phase I - Foundation And Evidence

September-December 2026

### Priority outputs:

- Strategic Council;
- NGO platform or partnership;
- GIS Observatory;
- Gazetteer;
- cadastral research;
- initial environmental baseline;
- ICPDR preparation;
- WILDisland dossier;
- conference strategy.

### Phase Ii - Internationalization

2027

### Priority outputs:

- conference presentations;
- academic publications;
- ICPDR participation;
- environmental partnerships;
- annual atlas;
- environmental status report;
- institutional briefings.

### Phase Iii - Institutional Embedding

2027-2028

### Priority outputs:

- recurring participation;
- research partnerships;
- NGO cooperation;
- scientific networks;
- workshops;
- transboundary environmental dialogue.

The objective is to ensure that Gornja Siga becomes a recurring and documented subject of professional discussion.

### Phase Iv - Consolidation And Special Status Options

2028-2030

### Develop and evaluate:

- scientific research zone;
- ecological stewardship arrangement;
- conservation-management model;
- cooperative management framework;
- transboundary environmental monitoring proposal;
- other legally and politically feasible arrangements.

## 24. Risk Matrix

| Risk | Level | Response |
|---|---|---|
| Political rejection | High | Maintain scientific and environmental independence |
| Misinterpretation of research as propaganda | High | Separate facts, evidence and political arguments |
| Legal restrictions on access | High | Obtain advice and use lawful procedures |
| Environmental data limitations | Medium | Use transparent methodology and uncertainty statements |
| Institutional non-response | Medium | Develop multiple parallel channels |
| Overreliance on one organization | High | Diversify institutional engagement |
| Reputational damage from confrontation | High | Apply strict non-confrontation protocol |
| Insufficient funding | Medium | Develop NGO, academic and project partnerships |
| Data licensing restrictions | Medium | Verify licences and attribution requirements |

## 25. Measurable Indicators Of Success

Success should be measured through objective indicators.

### Geographic indicators

- number of maps produced;
- number of GIS datasets;
- number of documented references to Gornja Siga;
- number of metadata records.

### Academic indicators

- conference abstracts;
- presentations;
- peer-reviewed publications;
- citations;
- institutional research partnerships.

### Environmental indicators

- biodiversity records;
- environmental reports;
- participation in conservation initiatives;
- monitoring datasets.

### Institutional indicators

- formal submissions;
- meetings;
- correspondence;
- workshop participation;
- NGO partnerships.

### Long-term indicators

- inclusion of Gornja Siga in relevant scientific discussions;
- recurring institutional awareness;
- development of concrete management or cooperation proposals.

## 26. Final Strategic Principle

The entire Strategy rests upon one central concept:

Gornja Siga should become increasingly difficult to ignore as a geographical, scientific and environmental reality regardless of the continuing differences concerning its political or legal interpretation.

The strongest long-term position will not be created by one declaration alone.

It will be created by the accumulation of:

**Data / Maps / Toponym / Geographic Record / Cadastral Research / Scientific Citation / Environmental Value / Ngo Involvement / Conference Presence / Institutional Dialogue / International Visibility / Documented Stakeholder Status / Enhanced Negotiating Position / Possible Cooperative Or Special Management Arrangement**

# Conclusion

The Gornja Siga Status Strategy 2026-2030 establishes a comprehensive framework combining research, cartography, GIS, cadastral investigation, environmental stewardship, NGO participation, international institutional engagement, conference diplomacy and long-term policy development.

Its central innovation is the use of multiple parallel channels rather than reliance upon a single political recognition process.

The Strategy recognizes that:

- a map does not itself establish sovereignty;
- a toponym does not itself establish statehood;
- environmental participation does not itself resolve a territorial dispute;
- conference presence does not itself create legal status;
- and institutional dialogue does not itself transfer authority.

However, taken together, these activities can create something strategically important:

A permanent, documented, internationally distributed body of geographic, scientific, environmental and institutional evidence concerning Gornja Siga.

The immediate task is therefore to move from isolated activities toward a permanent strategic architecture, in which every map, conference, publication, NGO partnership, environmental report, institutional submission and geospatial dataset contributes to one coordinated long-term objective:

THE ESTABLISHMENT OF GORNJA SIGA AS A PERMANENTLY DOCUMENTED, GEOGRAPHICALLY IDENTIFIABLE, ENVIRONMENTALLY RELEVANT AND INTERNATIONALLY ENGAGED DANUBE RIVER ISLAND.